Analyzing the BYD - Build Your Dreams Website

Case Study

Basic Observations

Observation: Users land on the homepage and are immediately presented with a large, visually appealing hero section featuring a prominent image of a BYD vehicle.

Purpose: The hero section's primary purpose is to capture attention and showcase the brand's flagship products, likely aiming to evoke a sense of luxury and innovation.

Observation: Below the hero section, there's a clear call-to-action (CTA) button encouraging users to "Build Your Dream."

Purpose: This CTA is the core functionality of the website, guiding users towards the configuration process.

Observation: The header menu includes options like "Models," "Discover BYD," "Where to Buy," and "Support."

Purpose: These options provide users with access to different sections of the website, allowing them to explore BYD's offerings, learn more about the company, find dealerships, and access support resources.

Observation: The footer menu contains links to "Terms of Use," "Privacy Policy," and "Cookie Policy."

Purpose: These links are standard legal pages that provide users with information about the website's terms and conditions, privacy practices, and cookie usage.

Observation: The website utilizes a consistent color scheme, typography, and overall design aesthetic throughout.

Purpose: This consistency helps create a cohesive brand experience and reinforces BYD's identity.

Observation: The website is responsive, adapting to different screen sizes and devices.

Purpose: This ensures a good user experience regardless of whether users are accessing the website on a desktop, tablet, or mobile phone.

Nielsen's 10 Usability Heuristics

1. Visibility of System Status: Page transitions, scroll cues, and form interactions provide clear feedback, keeping users aware of their location and actions.

2. Match Between System & the Real World: BYD uses familiar automotive terms, but the navigation could be more intuitive for non-technical users.

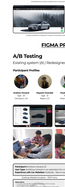
3. User Control & Freedom: Users can navigate freely, but the lack of a clear way to go back to the homepage from deep pages can be frustrating.

4. Consistency & Standards: The design is consistent, but labeling, such as "Where to Buy" vs. "Dealers," could be more standardized.

5. Error Prevention: Error prevention is limited, as there's usually no way to undo mistakes.

6. Recognition Rather Than Recall: Users must recall vehicle names across the site, as there's no persistent comparison feature.

7. Flexibility & Efficiency of Use: The website lacks shortcuts, offering a straightforward but potentially slow experience for frequent users.



8. Aesthetic & Minimalist Design: The design is modern, but content density is high, and sections feel cluttered.

9. Help Users Recognize, Diagnose, & Recover From Errors: Error messages are rare, but when they appear, they're unhelpful.

10. Help & Documentation: Help is limited to FAQs, lacking comprehensive guides or tutorials.

Automobile Brand Website Rankings

Note: Brand scores are assessed on a scale from 0 to 100, with higher scores indicating better performance in each category. The overall score is the average of the scores in all categories.

Competitive Analysis

Strengths:
- Strong emphasis on visual appeal and brand storytelling.
- Clear calls to action for configuration and test drives.
- Comprehensive information about vehicles and features.

Weaknesses:
- Navigation can be complex and overwhelming.
- Limited interactivity and engagement features.
- Lack of personalization options.

Defined Research Goal

Goal: To evaluate the usability and effectiveness of the BYD website in guiding users through the vehicle configuration process.

Target Audience

Primary Audience: Individuals considering purchasing a BYD vehicle.

User Scenarios

Scenario 1: A user wants to configure a specific BYD model with desired options and colors.

Scenario 2: A user wants to find the nearest BYD dealership to schedule a test drive.

Storyboarding

Task Flow

Task scenario: Configure a specific BYD car model.

Task flow: Homepage → Select Model → Choose Trim → Customize Options → Review Configuration → Schedule Test Drive / Find Dealership

USABILITY TESTING PLAN

Pre-Testing	Testing	Post-Testing
Before the test	During the test	After the test

Pre-Testing

Number of Participants: 20%-5?

Recruitment Criteria: Individuals who have expressed interest in purchasing a new vehicle within the next 12 months, have visited automotive websites in the past month, and are willing to participate in a usability test.

Test Location	Location Justification	Facility Requirements	Test Format	Number of Users	Moderator
Remote	Allows for a wider range of participants and convenience for users.	Stable internet connection, video conferencing software.	Moderated usability testing.	5-7 users	1 moderator

Individuals	Individuals	Moderator
Observe user behavior and take notes.	Observe user behavior and take notes.	Facilitate the test and ask questions.

Usability Testing Tasks:

Data Collection Methods:

Qualitative Data	Quantitative Data
Think-aloud protocol: Encourage users to verbalize their thoughts and feelings during the test. Post-test questionnaire: Collect subjective feedback on the website's usability.	Task completion rates: Measure the percentage of users who successfully complete each task. Time on task: Measure the time it takes users to complete each task.

Participant Profiles:

Testing

Quantitative Data

- Task Success Rate: 80%
- Average Time on Task: 5 min

Post-Testing

Proposed User-Centered Redesign Solutions (UCD-Based):

Issue Identified	Proposed Solution
Information Overload	Implement a clean, minimalist design with clear visual hierarchy.
Navigation	Add a persistent header with clear navigation options.
Configuration Process	Simplify the configuration process with a step-by-step wizard.
Dealership Locator	Integrate a map-based dealership locator with filtering options.
Mobile Responsiveness	Ensure the website is fully responsive and optimized for mobile devices.

Observed User Challenges:

Actionable Recommendations:

1. Simplify the Configuration Process
2. Enhance Visual Hierarchy
3. Improve Navigation
4. Optimize for Mobile Devices
5. Integrate a Dealership Locator
6. Add Comparison Features
7. Improve Content Clarity
8. Implement Personalization Options
9. Improve Navigation Flow
10. Add Interactive Elements

Prioritization: Prioritize recommendations based on their impact on user experience and feasibility of implementation.

Redesigning the BYD Website

A - Existing Website

B - Redesign

FIGMA PROTOTYPE

A/B Testing

Existing system (A) / Redesigned prototype (B)

Participants Profiles:

Testing

Feature User Validation Table:

Validated Features	User Validation
Clear and concise information about BYD models	All users
Easy-to-use configuration tool	All users
Accurate pricing information	All users
Convenient dealership locator	All users
Seamless test drive booking process	All users
Comprehensive FAQ section	All users
Responsive design for mobile devices	All users
Fast loading times	All users
Secure online transactions	All users
Helpful customer support options	All users

Average BYD Driving Efficiency Statistic: 14.8/100

Average BYD Battery Degradation Statistic: 95.8%

The battery health test data is a crucial component of the overall evaluation of the BYD vehicle's performance and reliability. The high average battery health percentage of 95.8% indicates that the vehicle's battery is maintaining its capacity well over time, which is a positive sign for long-term ownership and resale value.

Conclusion

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